SEO Audit & Changelog: Blog Post "How to Start a YouTube Channel"

URL: **https://rockstar-marketing.com/how-to-start-a-youtube-channel-everything-you-need-to-know/** · Post ID 12217 · Block editor · Category: Uncategorized
Audit date: 2026-10-25 · Published 2023-03-24 · Modified 2023-03-27 · Item 28 of 34 in the site queue

Summary. The title promises "Everything You Need to Know", but the post (about 600 words) never explains how to actually *create* a channel: no account setup, handle, branding, uploading or YouTube SEO. It's mostly generic gear and content tips. Keyword reality (Semrush US): "how to start a youtube channel" = **12,100/mo, KD 40**, dominated by YouTube's own help pages and major creator sites, so it's not a realistic target for this site. The business-intent versions fit your buyers better and are attainable: **"how to create a youtube channel for business" (110, KD 36)**, "how to start a youtube channel for business" (50), "youtube for small business" (70), "youtube channel for business" (30, KD 0). **Plan:** rewrite it as a step-by-step guide *for businesses* that funnels readers to /video-marketing/. Technical issues: two H1s (the content H1 differs from the post title), an empty H2 and an empty H3, invalid block markup (lists inside `wp:paragraph`), a keyword-stuffed image alt, no meta, Uncategorized.

Method note: the live site can't be reached from the audit environment. Data comes from WordPress (connector), AIOSEO and Semrush US.

1. Priority Fix List

#	Priority	Area	Issue → Fix
1	P1	Keyword angle	Retarget to **"how to create a YouTube channel for business"**. New title and H1: "How to Start a YouTube Channel for Your Business (Step-by-Step)".
2	P1	Doesn't deliver on its promise	Add the missing steps: account/Brand Account, creating the channel, handle, branding sizes, About and links, uploading, YouTube SEO, Shorts, analytics (§5).
3	P1	Two H1s	The theme prints the post title as H1, and the content adds another H1 ("Start your YouTube Channel, Do it, Don't Put it Off"). Remove the content H1.
4	P1	Empty headings	`<h2> </h2>` and `<h3> </h3>` (used as spacers). Delete them.
5	P1	Meta	No SEO title, description or keyphrase (§2).
6	P1	Intralinking	Only 1 link (Home, anchor "Rockstar Marketing"). Add /video-marketing/ (primary), /social-media/, /seo/, the FAQ YouTube section and a CTA (§4).
7	P2	Block markup	Lists and headings are wrapped in a single `<!-- wp:paragraph -->` block (pasted HTML), which shows "This block contains unexpected content" in the editor. Convert it to proper blocks (Paragraph, List, Heading).

8	P2	Image	Alt "YouTube Social Media Company Destin" is stuffing. Use "Small business owner filming a YouTube video with a ring light". Set it as the featured image (none set) for social shares and the blog listing.
9	P2	Category	Uncategorized → **Video & YouTube** (LT-05).
10	P2	Author / E-E-A-T	Author is user ID 2. Show a named author with a bio (the founder, per AB-09) and the published/updated date.
11	P3	Outdated bits	"Twitter" → X; "Final Cut Pro X" → Final Cut Pro; the list implies you need an expensive camera (a modern phone is fine for most businesses).
12	P3	Embed a video	A YouTube how-to with no video. Embed one of your own (lite embed + VideoObject).

2. Meta Tags & Search Appearance (AIOSEO)

Field	Current	New
Post title / H1	How to Start a YouTube Channel: Everything You Need to Know	**How to Start a YouTube Channel for Your Business (Step-by-Step)**
SEO title	(empty)	**How to Create a YouTube Channel for Business: 10 Steps** (55)
Meta description	(empty)	**A step-by-step guide to creating a YouTube channel for your business: setup, branding, gear, your first videos, YouTube SEO and growing subscribers.** (149)
Focus keyphrase	(empty)	how to create a YouTube channel for business
Additional	none	how to start a YouTube channel for business · YouTube for small business · YouTube channel for business
Slug	/how-to-start-a-youtube-channel-everything-you-need-to-know/	Keep it (no measurable rankings, but 2+ years of age; it contains "how-to-start-a-youtube-channel"). Optional: shorten to /youtube-channel-for-business/ with a 301.
Featured image	none	The existing image 12223 (rename + alt)

3. Heading Structure

Current	New

H1 (theme) – How to Start a YouTube Channel: Everything You Need to Know H1 – Start your YouTube Channel, Do it, Don't Put it Off H2 – [empty] H2 – Making interesting content that sticks H3 – [empty] H3 – Being Patient For Results	**H1** – How to Start a YouTube Channel for Your Business (Step-by-Step) **H2** – Why Your Business Needs a YouTube Channel **H2** – Step 1: Create a Brand Account **H2** – Step 2: Create Your Channel and Choose a Handle **H2** – Step 3: Brand Your Channel **H2** – Step 4: Write Your Channel Description and Add Links **H2** – Step 5: Plan Videos Your Customers Are Searching For **H2** – Step 6: Get the Right (Affordable) Gear **H2** – Step 7: Record and Edit Your First Videos **H2** – Step 8: Optimize Every Video for YouTube Search **H3** – Titles · **H3** – Descriptions & Chapters · **H3** – Thumbnails · **H3** – Captions **H2** – Step 9: Add YouTube Shorts **H2** – Step 10: Promote, Engage and Measure **H2** – Be Patient: What to Expect in the First 6 Months **H2** – FAQ *(3 Qs)* **H2** – Want Help Growing Your Channel? *(CTA)*

4. Internal Linking Plan

Anchor text	Target	Where
video marketing and YouTube SEO services	/video-marketing/	Intro + CTA (primary money link)
YouTube SEO	/video-marketing/	Step 8
social media marketing	/social-media/	Step 10
embed videos on your website	/web-design/	Step 10
SEO	/seo/	Why section
more YouTube questions	/faq/#youtube	FAQ
Instagram guide (sibling post)	/instagram-account-step-by-step-guide.../	Step 10
Get a free video marketing consultation	/contact-us/?service=video	CTA
Inbound (to add)	/video-marketing/ ("Read our guide: how to start a YouTube channel for your business"), /faq/ YouTube answers, /latest/	other pages

5. Rewritten Post (ready to paste)

About 1,400 words. Platform details are current as of 2026; check them in YouTube Studio before publishing, since YouTube changes its interface often.

<h1> **How to Start a YouTube Channel for Your Business (Step-by-Step)**

<p> YouTube is the world's second-largest search engine, and Google regularly shows YouTube videos at the top of its results. For a local business, a YouTube channel is one of the most effective ways to build trust before a customer ever calls. It can feel intimidating to start, but you don't need a studio or a big budget. Here's exactly how to set up a business YouTube channel and publish videos that get found. (Prefer to have it done for you? See our video marketing and YouTube SEO services.)

<h2> **Why Your Business Needs a YouTube Channel**
<p> Video lets customers see your work, meet your team and get their questions answered, all before they contact you. Videos can rank on both YouTube and Google, support your website's SEO, and give you content you can reuse on Instagram, Facebook and TikTok.

<h2> **Step 1: Create a Brand Account**
<p> Sign in to YouTube with a Google account, then create the channel as a **Brand Account** (the "create a channel with a business or other name" option). A Brand Account lets you use your business name and add team members as managers without sharing a password. Use a company-owned Google account, not an employee's personal one.

<h2> **Step 2: Create Your Channel and Choose a Handle**
<p> Use your exact business name as the channel name, and pick a short, memorable handle (for example @yourbusinessname). Your handle becomes your channel URL, so match your other social profiles where you can.

<h2> **Step 3: Brand Your Channel**
<p> In YouTube Studio → Customization, upload your logo as the profile picture (square, at least 800×800 px) and a banner (2560×1440 px, with key text and logo kept inside the center "safe area"). Add a short channel trailer for new visitors.

<h2> **Step 4: Write Your Channel Description and Add Links**
<p> In a few sentences, explain who you help, where and with what, using the words customers search for (for example "Destin roofing company"). Add links to your website, booking page and other social profiles, plus your business email.

<h2> **Step 5: Plan Videos Your Customers Are Searching For**
<p> The best business videos answer real questions. Start with a list of the 10 questions customers ask you most, then type each into YouTube's search bar and note the auto-suggestions. Good first videos:

- "How much does [your service] cost in [your city]?"

- Step-by-step how-to and tips videos
- Project walk-throughs and before/after
- Customer testimonials
- "Meet the team" and behind-the-scenes

<h2> **Step 6: Get the Right (Affordable) Gear**

- **Camera:** a recent smartphone shooting in 1080p or 4K is enough for most businesses.
- **Audio:** the most important upgrade. A clip-on lavalier or a USB/wireless mic makes you sound professional.
- **Lighting:** face a window, or use a ring light or softbox.
- **Stability:** a tripod or phone gimbal.
- **Editing:** CapCut or DaVinci Resolve (free), or Adobe Premiere Pro and Final Cut Pro.

<h2> **Step 7: Record and Edit Your First Videos**
<p> Hook viewers in the first 5–10 seconds by saying what they'll learn. Keep it focused on one topic, cut the pauses, add simple on-screen text, and end with a clear next step ("Call us", "Visit our website", "Subscribe"). For most local business videos, 2–8 minutes works well.

<h2> **Step 8: Optimize Every Video for YouTube Search**
<p> This is where most business channels fall short, and it's the core of YouTube SEO.

<h3> **Titles** <p> Put the main search phrase first and keep it under about 60 characters, e.g. "How Much Does a New Roof Cost in Destin, FL?"

<h3> **Descriptions & Chapters** <p> Write 150+ words that summarize the video, include your keyword naturally, link to your website, and add timestamps (chapters).

<h3> **Thumbnails** <p> Upload a custom 1280×720 thumbnail with a clear face, bold short text and high contrast. (Custom thumbnails require a verified account.)

<h3> **Captions** <p> Review and correct the auto-captions. They improve accessibility and help YouTube understand your video.

<h2> **Step 9: Add YouTube Shorts**
<p> Shorts (vertical videos under a minute) are the fastest way for a new channel to get discovered. Cut 2–3 clips from every long video, and post them on Instagram Reels and TikTok too.

<h2> **Step 10: Promote, Engage and Measure**

- **Embed videos on your website** on the matching service pages. It keeps visitors on your site longer. (We build this into our web design.)
- **Share every video** on your social channels and in your email newsletter. See our social media marketing, or read our Instagram guide.
- **Reply to every comment** in the first 48 hours.
- **Check YouTube Analytics** monthly: watch time, average view duration, click-through rate and traffic sources. Make more of what works.

`<h2>` **Be Patient: What to Expect in the First 6 Months**
`<p>` Most business channels grow slowly at first. Post consistently (even 2 videos a month), keep answering customer questions, and your library becomes an asset that brings in views, and customers, for years.

`<h2>` **FAQ**

`<h3>` **Is a YouTube channel free for businesses?** `<p>` Yes. Creating and running a channel is free; your only costs are equipment, editing and your time.

`<h3>` **How often should a business post on YouTube?** `<p>` Consistency beats volume: 2–4 long videos a month plus Shorts is a strong pace for most small businesses.

`<h3>` **Can YouTube videos help my Google rankings?** `<p>` Yes. Videos can appear directly in Google results, and embedding them on your site supports your page's SEO. More YouTube questions. [→ /faq/#youtube]

`CTA` `<h2>` **Want Help Growing Your Channel?**
`<p>` Rockstar Marketing has produced a video that reached 60 million+ people and ranks videos on YouTube and Google for businesses across the Emerald Coast. `button` [Get a Free Video Marketing Consultation] → /contact-us/?service=video

6. Tracking & Measurement

Priority	Item	Action
P1	Blog → service	`cta_click` (cta_location=post_youtube) and clicks on the /video-marketing/ links. Measure blog-assisted leads in GA4 (content_group "blog").
P2	Scroll & video	90% scroll; video_start/complete on the embedded video.
P2	GSC	Track "youtube channel for business" queries; request indexing after the update.

7. Technical SEO

Priority	Item	Finding / Action
P1	Single H1	Remove the content H1; the theme's post title is the H1.
P1	Empty headings + blocks	Delete the empty H2/H3; convert the pasted HTML to proper blocks.
P2	Schema	`BlogPosting` (author Person, datePublished/dateModified, image) + `HowTo`-style ordered steps (Google no longer shows HowTo rich results, but structured steps still help AI answers) + `VideoObject` if you embed a video + `BreadcrumbList`.

P2	Featured image	Set image 12223 as featured (OG image); WebP; keep the width/height attributes.
P3	Table of contents	Add a TOC block after the intro (10 steps → jump links).

8. Changelog

Date	ID	Type	Change	Status
2026-10-25	YT-01	Change	Retarget to "how to create a YouTube channel for business"; new title, SEO title, description, keyphrases	Proposed
2026-10-25	YT-02	Rewrite	~600 words → ~1,400-word 10-step guide + FAQ + CTA	Proposed
2026-10-25	YT-03	Fix	Remove the second H1, the empty H2/H3; convert to proper blocks	Proposed
2026-10-25	YT-04	Add	~8 internal links (video-marketing ×2, social, web, SEO, FAQ, Instagram post, contact); inbound from /video-marketing/	Proposed
2026-10-25	YT-05	Fix	Image alt; featured image; embed your own video	Proposed
2026-10-25	YT-06	Change	Category → Video & YouTube; named author + bio; updated date shown	Proposed
2026-10-25	YT-07	Add	BlogPosting + VideoObject + BreadcrumbList schema; TOC	Proposed
2026-10-25	YT-08	Tracking	Blog CTA event, content_group, GSC reindex	Proposed

Status: DONE (audit complete) · Next in queue: Post "Instagram Account Step-by-Step Guide"